



Compromised Linux Webserver:

Manual Incident Inspection,
Securing and Lockdown Workshop

By : Thomas "Tweeks" Weeks
For : 2026 USCC Summer Camp
Date : 2026-06-10
These Slides : tinyurl.com/compd-linux-server-slides

About Me



Name: "Tweeks" (aka Thomas Weeks)
Position: (VT) Director of Future Technology/Community (VACR) Lead Engineer
Previous: 30+ yrs in IT (VT, Rackspace Hosting, DoD Contr)

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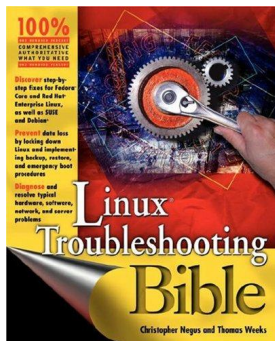
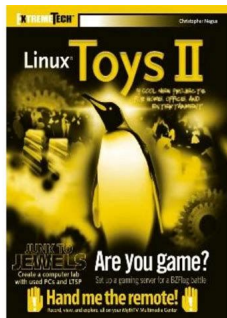
<https://fb.com/ThomasW.Weeks>

@tweeks_tx

Signal - tweeks.01

Various Jobs Over 30yrs:

- Sys-Admin / Engineer, Product Engineer, Sys. Architect
- Data Center RCA Team Lead, Cloud RCA Lead
- RHCE / Corp. Technical Trainer / Tech Writer
- Training & STEM Outreach, Tech Community Relations
- co-authored a couple Linux books



VIRGINIA
CYBER RANGE

Workshop Resources

Needed Workshop Resources:

- Solid Linux CLI / services experience (on older CentOS)
- A Laptop w/solid network connection
- The Hands on Lab "Handouts" - [Cheatsheet](#) & [Exercise](#)
- Cyber Range Invite - go.vacr.io/uscc-am-invite →
- Google/MS-Azure OAuth login (e.g. gmail || azure)
- Bookmark VM Link - go.vacr.io/uscc-am-vms



Slides: <https://tinyurl.com/compd-linux-server-slides>

Hacked Webserver Lab Overview

Hands on Incident Response:

Documenting a Compromised Linux Webserver:

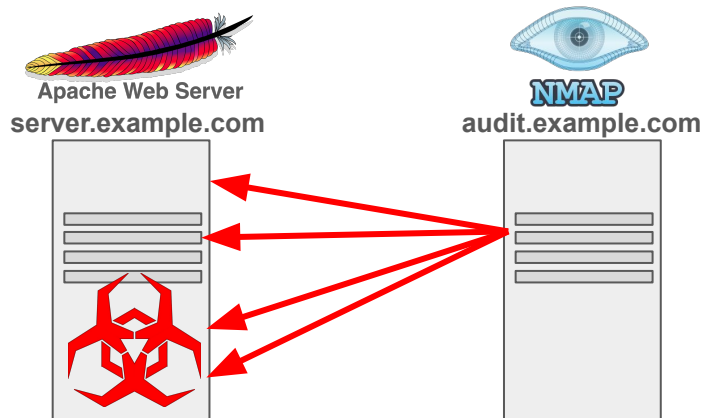
- **SCAN:** Inspect your systems network-port bindings locally (netstat) and remotely scan (nmap)
- **ID PORTS:** Identify and document any non-standard/anomalous exposed network ports
- **ID PROCESSES:** Identify/collect bad processes, kill/eliminate them (verify w/reboot)
- **VERIFY BINARIES:** Verifying system binaries are all “clean”
- **REMOVE MALWARE:** Remove and clean up any compromised system files/configurations
- **IS IT STABLE?** Verify that system in a stable, semi-secured state after reboots
- **End goal:** Document findings, clean up compromised binaries/files, lock down the system to prevent further re-infection until a VM date migration can take place.

Your Virtual Machines

Your VM Setup:

You have two VMs.

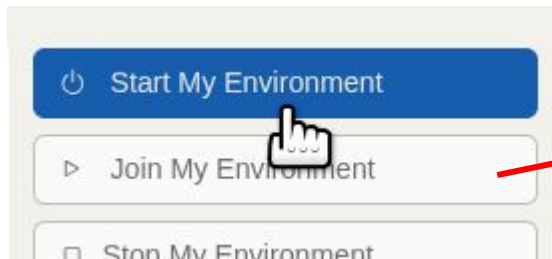
1. An apache web server, that has been infected with self-re-infecting malware.
2. An audit server that you can do external portscans from



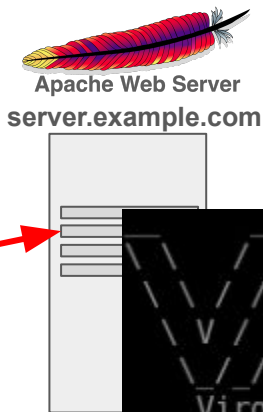
Your Virtual Machines

Logging into your VM:

1. Use invite to get into the range: <https://go.vacr.io/uscc-am-invite>
2. Bookmark your environment: <https://go.vacr.io/uscc-am-vms>
3. Start and join your server



join
ssh



Your Virtual Machines

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3. Start and join your server
4. Start a screen session, ssh into audit server,
5. Scan your server from audit.
6. Mop up, rescan, document findings and answer questions



```
[root@server ~]#  
1 bash  
[root@server ~]#  
[root@server ~]# nmap -sS -T4 server.example.com | grep -v "^$"  
Starting Nmap 6.40 ( http://nmap.org ) at 2026-06-10 01:46 UTC  
Nmap scan report for server.example.com (10.1.41.157)  
Host is up (0.0000030s latency).  
rDNS record for 10.1.41.157: ip-10-1-41-157.ec2.internal  
Not shown: 997 closed ports  
PORT      STATE SERVICE  
22/tcp    open  ssh  
80/tcp    open  http  
111/tcp   open  rpcbind  
Nmap done: 1 IP address (1 host up) scanned in 0.10 seconds  
[root@server ~]#  
2 bash
```



Questions & Resources

QUESTIONS?

Let's Do It!

These slides (see bottom)

Invite into range: <https://go.vacr.io/uscc-am-invite>

your environment: <https://go.vacr.io/uscc-am-vms>

Lab "Handouts": [Cheatsheet](#) & [Exercise](#) PDFs

Slides : go.vacr.io/using-shared-networks



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CYBER RANGE

The Crew of The Virginia Cyber Range

